

gets the files that the installer would normally place in the installation folder, into another folder of your choice by making the installer behave as an archive. Keep in mind that this is trial and error method and may not work with all applications. Once you have the installer files with you, you need to download an application called the "Universal Extractor". Once you have the application, run it, and in the window that opens up, choose the correct option to select the installer to be extracted. It also lets you select the target folder, which is the same folder as the installer by default. Once you have done this, you will be prompted to select the extraction method. If you are not sure about the method here, try each choice once until you get the extracted files in that folder. Now you can simply copy these files onto a USB and run them on a computer of your choice.

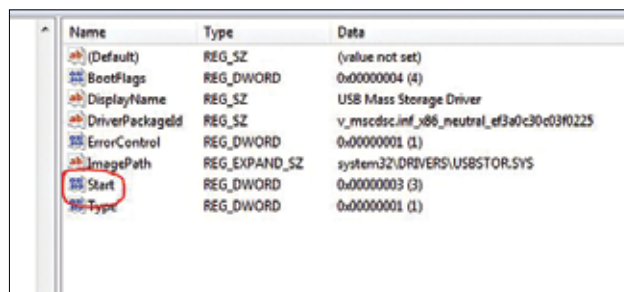
UNBLOCK PORTS

For this one, you will absolutely need admin access, so refer to the earlier part of this article if you skipped it. Once you're done with that, or if you already have admin rights, there are essentially four ways in which an admin could have blocked your USB ports, and we are quickly going to take all four of them down!

- **Method 1** – go to Start > Run and type regedit and hit [Enter]. Navigate to HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SYSTEM\CurrentControlSet\Services\

USBSTOR and on the right pane, click on Start and change the value to 3, then hit OK.

- **Method 2** – Just check the device manager, as ports can be disabled from here as well. Right click on a selected port and click on Enable



Name	Type	Data
(Default)	REG_SZ	(value not set)
BootFlags	REG_DWORD	0x00000004 (4)
DisplayName	REG_SZ	USB Mass Storage Driver
DriverPackageId	REG_SZ	v_mscdsc.inf_x86_neutral_ef3a0c30c03f0225
ErrorControl	REG_DWORD	0x00000001 (1)
ImagePath	REG_EXPAND_SZ	system32\DRIVERS\USBSTOR.SYS
Start	REG_DWORD	0x00000003 (3)
Type	REG_DWORD	0x00000001 (1)

The default value on an untampered system should be 3

- **Method 3** – If your sys-admin has gone one step further and uninstalled the USB drivers completely, simply plugging your USB device back into the machine should start a search for the right drivers and their subsequent installation.
- **Method 4** – Get a third party tool to enable USB ports. Such tools are usually one-click solutions to enable/disable ports, and you can find quite a few good ones online.

ACCESS THE TASKMANAGER

Thanks to the super efficient operating system that Windows has been, and the tendency of school or work systems to be 'extremely generous' with configurations (that's sarcasm), sometimes the only option one is left with is opening up the task manager and killing unnecessary processes. Sadly sss-admins have been known to block

this as well. You need one all powerful tool to get beyond this unbreachable wall, and that tool is...(cue drumroll).... Microsoft Word!!!

No, we're not kidding, really. There is a loophole in Microsoft's Office software for creating documents that has associated a 'Tasks' property to it, that conveniently returns a list of all the processes running on the computer. There are a number of things you can do with this loophole which involve running some scripts using the command prompt, that lets you do all sorts of things like getting a list of processes, closing a process or even maximising

it. Check out the exact process here – <https://technet.microsoft.com/en-us/library/ff405673.aspx>

CAUTION!

Again, we want to reiterate that most of what we've shown you here can actually land you in serious trouble. Losing a job might just turn out to be the smallest punishment for you. Before you run amuck on your work or college network using these hacks, please think things true carefully. Maybe, instead of being malicious, it would be best to approach your system admin and work on this together as a project to test whether these hacks work. She might just turn out to be grateful for showing her these tricks, and allow you to bend or even break some rules in the interest of white hat hacking and helping secure the network! Then again, maybe not. Either way, be warned! 

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